

Design Document - My Personal Homepage

Project Description

This is my personal homepage. It's a small static website I built using plain HTML, CSS, and JavaScript (with ES6 modules), no React, no Bootstrap, no fancy libraries.

The site has three pages: a Home page that introduces me, a Portfolio showing the stuff I've built, and a Fun Facts page (which I generated with AI assistance for full transparency). The fun part is a quiz I made called "Are you cool enough to be friends with Priyan?" It's a small interactive thing that hopefully makes people remember my site.

The site is live on [Github Pages](#).

Goals:

- Build something that looks decent without copy pasting a template
- Make progressive improvements on code with a slight help of the internet and LLMs.
- Make the site feel like ME, not a generic dev portfolio
- Practice using ES6 modules, proper folder structure, Prettier, and ESLint.

User Personas:

I tried to think about the real people who'd land on my site and what they'd want. Here are the three I had in mind:

1. A Recruiter

Probably a tech recruiter looking at my application. She has 30 other tabs open and maybe 90 seconds before she decides if I'm interesting. She doesn't care about my personality at first, she wants to know what I've built, what tech I use and whether I can do the job. She'll scan the Portfolio page, click through to my GitHub, and only read the bio if the projects catch her eye.

What she needs from me: A clear bio, projects with tech stacks visible, easy-to-find contact info, and a GitHub link that actually works.

2. A Classmate

Another grad student at Northeastern, probably looking around to see what people in the program are building, maybe wants to collaborate, probably appreciates clean design and gets bored of standard portfolios.

What he needs from me: Something that doesn't feel like every other student's site. The not so serious quiz, the AI disclosure and the personality stuff matter here.

3. A Friend

A non-technical friend who saw my Instagram story about the site. She'll be on her phone. She doesn't care about my GPA or my Java backend services, she wants to see the fun stuff, take the quiz, and maybe share it.

What she needs from me: Responsiveness, the friendship quiz, and personality. If the Home page is just a wall of resume text, she's gone.

User Stories:

Story 1: The Recruiter

A recruiter clicks my portfolio link from my resume. The site loads, she sees my name, reads my one-sentence bio ("MS CS @ Northeastern, Software Developer"), and decides whether to keep going. She clicks Portfolio, scans the project cards (the Adversarial Pursuit-Evasion game catches her eye because it has "Reinforcement Learning" as a tag), clicks the GitHub link to verify I actually wrote the code. Goal: get her interested enough to schedule a call.

Story 2: The Friend

My friend opens my site on her phone after I sent her the link. The page loads cleanly. She doesn't read the bio, she scrolls until she finds the quiz, takes it, gets 3/5, screenshots her result, sends it to our group chat. Now five more people open my site to take the quiz. Goal: be memorable, not just "another portfolio."

Story 3: The Classmate

A fellow grad student is browsing portfolios for inspiration on a Friday night. He goes through my Portfolio, clicks into a couple of GitHub repos to see how I structured the code. Then he visits Fun Facts out of curiosity, sees the AI disclosure at the bottom, and respects that I was upfront about it. Goal: be respected by peers, maybe spark a collab.

Design Mockups:

The look

I went with a dark theme inspired by Spotify and GitHub which was my go-to theme that I have always wanted to design. Both are tools I use every day, and the dark mode with a single bright accent color (Spotify green in my case) feels modern.

Colors I used:

- Deep black for the main background (#0d1117)
- Slightly lighter gray for cards (#161b22)
- Spotify green for accents and buttons (#1db954)
- Off-white for primary text (#e6edf3)

- Muted gray for secondary text (#8b949e)

Fonts: Inter for headings and body (clean, modern sans-serif), JetBrains Mono for code-looking elements like stats and tags (gives the page a developery feel).

Page layouts:

Home Page

A big hero section at the top with my name, a one line tagline, and a short bio. Below that, four stat cards (years of experience, GPA, languages I know, cups of filter coffee). Then a timeline of where I've been. Northeastern, Hitachi Energy, Anna University. The quiz is the last section before the footer.

Portfolio Page

A grid of project cards. Each one has an emoji icon, the project name, a short description, tech tags and a GitHub link. Below the projects is a skills section grouped into Languages, Databases, Tools, and AI/ML because dumping 30 skills into one big list doesn't tell you anything.

Fun Facts Page

A grid of 8 small cards with random fun facts about me. AI-generated, with a clear note at the bottom saying so.

The thing that makes my site different: "Are You Cool Enough?"

Most personal homepages do the same thing. There's a bio, some project cards, maybe a contact form and you're done. I wanted my site to be something people would actually remember a week later, not just another tab they closed.

So I built a quiz. It's called **"Are You Cool Enough to Be Friends with Priyan?"** and it sits on my Home page right under my bio. The idea is simple, five questions, four options each, and at the end you get a score out of 5 with a roast or a compliment depending on how you did. The whole thing is one ES6 module that I import into my main script file.

Each answer is tagged as correct or incorrect in the code, and a running score tracks how many you got "right" (how many matched my actual preferences). At the end, you see a result page:

- **5/5:** "Best friend material. We're basically the same person."
- **4/5:** "Definitely cool enough. Welcome to the inner circle."
- **3/5:** "We could be friends. Mid-tier vibes but I see potential."
- **2/5 or below:** playful roasts

There's a "Try Again" button so people can replay and try to get a perfect score (which I've noticed people actually do).

Little details that I added

- Cards lift slightly when you hover over them (subtle, not annoying)
 - The accent color appears on hover borders too
 - Quiz options slide right a few pixels when you hover them (gives feedback that it's clickable)
 - The hand emoji on the home page actually waves (CSS animation)
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